

Innovation creates motion only when the enterprise can transmit it.

Actual mandate

Build and lead a measurable enterprise AI and digital-innovation system that converts distributed demand into production outcomes across Vontier's hardware, controls, software, payments, field, manufacturing, and customer environments.

Company moment

A newly appointed Chief Innovation and Growth Officer is charged with enterprise innovation, AI strategy, and digital modernization while Vontier accelerates Connected Mobility across approximately 25 countries and three operating segments.

Core tension

Preserve business-unit autonomy and customer speed while creating enough common architecture, evidence, governance, and learning to scale globally.

White-space thesis

Use VBS to establish a common AI evidence and deployment contract. Business units retain problem ownership and local judgment; the enterprise provides reusable patterns, security and data controls, MLOps, vendor leverage, adoption mechanisms, and transparent scale/continue/hold/stop decisions.

Operating artifact

Innovation Torque Converter: Open discovery -> controlled coupling -> production lock-up -> reusable learning return.

Candidate advantage

Industrial hardware/software operations + direct AI workflow design + distributed launch discipline + quality systems + regulated autonomous systems + sustainability grounding.

Enterprise scorecard

Dimension	Question	Evidence category
Business outcome	Did the solution improve the priority workflow or customer result?	Cycle time, uptime, yield, cost, revenue, risk, customer outcome
Production truth	Can it be deployed, monitored, supported, and changed safely?	Architecture, MLOps, edge/cloud behavior, validation, observability
Human authority	Who decides, overrides, escalates, and accepts residual risk?	Decision rights, exception policy, review records
Adoption	Did the people doing the work change behavior?	Use, completion, exception, trust, training, workflow adherence
Economics	Does the value justify build, run, change, and support cost?	Total cost, avoided work, service burden, reuse, time-to-value
Learning	What asset or insight returns to the portfolio?	Playbook, architecture, taxonomy, dataset, evaluation, stop signal

First 120 days

- 0-30: portfolio and system diagnosis
- 31-60: common contract and governance
- 61-90: production-shaped pilot portfolio
- 91-120: lock, publish assets, compound learning

Leadership line

"I would not centralize innovation. I would centralize the contracts that make innovation easier to trust, deploy, and reuse."

Interview outcome to seek

Agreement on the first two or three enterprise-scale problems worth coupling, the autonomy boundary between corporate and business units, the production evidence required to lock a pilot, and the executive cadence that makes stop decisions as legitimate as scale decisions.